

考研精读 | Economist



Dead wait

净土难安

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

The problem with the world's oldest **mummies**

世界上最古老的木乃伊遇到新问题

【 Para.1 】

Running 600km along the coast of the Atacama desert, from southern Peru to northern Chile, is a mass-burial site for the world's oldest mummies. The Chinchorro, who lived on the **strip** of coast from 7000BC to 1000bc, and survived by hunting and fishing, were **meticulous** preservers of their dead. Almost everyone who died could be mummified, with no regard for social status. This, combined with the dry environment of the Atacama, has led to an odd situation: the world's oldest **deliberately** preserved bodies are so numerous that they are creating problems.

阿塔卡马沙漠沿海地带有一处规模庞大的墓葬遗址，绵延约 600 公里，从秘鲁南部一直延伸至智利北部，那里埋葬着世界上最古老的木乃伊。公元前 7000 年至公元前 1000 年间，以狩猎和捕鱼为生的钦乔罗人在这

August 29TH- September 4TH | The Americas

文章导读：

世界最古老的钦查罗木乃伊出土于阿塔卡马沙漠沿岸。风沙侵蚀与人类活动加速遗骸暴露，但博物馆存储空间、保存条件不足，考古人员只能就地研究后重新掩埋。该遗址列入世界遗产，开发旅游带来机遇，却与当地居民生存诉求产生矛盾，相关保护项目仍面临诸多现实阻碍。

mummy n. /'mami/ a body of a human or an animal that has been mummified 木乃伊；经处理保存的人体或动物干尸

strip n. /stri:p/ a long narrow area of land, sea, etc. (陆地、海域等) 狭长地带；带状水域 【考研大纲词汇】

v. (~ sth off) (~ A off/from B)/ (~ B of A) to remove a layer from sth, especially so that it is completely exposed 除去，剥去（一层）；（尤指）剥光

Strip off all the existing paint. 把现有的油漆全部刮掉。

meticulous adj. /mə'tikjələs/ (~ in sth/doing sth) (~ about sth/in doing sth) paying careful attention to every detail 细心的；小心翼翼的 【考研大纲词汇】

deliberately adv. /di'libərətli/ done in a way that was planned, not by chance 故意；蓄意；存心 【考研大纲词汇】
adv. slowly and carefully 不慌不忙地；小心翼翼地；从容不迫地

He packed up his possessions slowly and deliberately. 他慢慢地、小心翼翼地收拾好自己的物品。

charge v. /tʃɑ:dʒ/ (~ sb with sth) (usually passive) (formal) to give sb a responsibility or task 赋予...职责（或任务）；使...承担责任（或任务） 【考研大纲词汇】

The committee has been **charged** with the development of sport in the region. 委员会已被赋予在该地区发展体育运动的职责。

v. (~ sb with sth/with doing sth) to accuse sb formally of a crime so that there can be a trial in court 控告；起诉

He was charged with murder. 他被指控犯有谋杀罪。

v. (~ sb with sth/with doing sth) (formal) to accuse sb publicly of doing sth wrong or bad 指责；谴责

Opposition MPs **charged** the minister with neglecting her duty. 反对党议员指责女部长玩忽职守。

v. (~ sth) (up) to pass electricity through sth so that it is stored there 给...充电

The shaver can be **charged** up and used when travelling. 这种电动剃须刀可充电供旅行使用。

stumble across/on/upon sth/sb phrasal verb to discover sth/sb unexpectedly 意外发现；偶然遇见

Police have **stumbled across** a huge drugs ring. 警方无意中发现一个庞大的贩毒集团。

stumble into sth phrasal verb to become involved in sth by chance 无意间涉足某事

I stumbled into acting when I left college. 我从大学出来后无意间进了演艺界。

片狭长海岸地带繁衍生息，他们对死者遗体进行了极为细致的保存。不论社会地位高低，几乎所有逝者都可以被制成木乃伊。加之阿塔卡马地区干燥的自然环境，这份历史如今带来了一个颇为奇特的局面：世界上最古老且经有意保存下来的遗体数量如此之多，以至于带来了许多难题。

【 Para.2 】

Lately, more bodies have been emerging from the earth. César Borie is an archaeologist with Chinchorro Marka, an agency that Chile's government has **charged** with the protection of the country's Chinchorro archaeological sites. He studies a skeleton that he **stumbled upon** while walking around Caleta Camarones, a town near the city of Arica in northern Chile. "We find new remains exposed every time we come here," he says, gently reburying the bones with his hands. "Keeping them under the soil until the conditions are right is the best we can do."

近来，越来越多的遗骸从土层中暴露出来。塞萨尔·博里（César Borie）是钦乔罗考古保护协会的一名考古学家。智利政府已委托该机构负责保护境内的钦乔罗考古遗址。此前，他在智利北部城市阿里卡附近的卡莱塔·卡马罗内斯镇一带走动时偶然发现了一具遗骸，目前正对其开展研究。“每次来到这里，我们都会发现有新的遗骸暴露在地表之上，”他说着，用双手轻轻地将这些骨头重新埋入土中。“在条件合适之前，让它们继续留在地下是目前最好的办法。”

issue from sth *phrasal verb* (formal) to come out of sth 从...中出来

A weak trembling sound **issued from** his lips. 他嘴里发出了微弱颤抖的声音。

initial adj. /iˈniʃl/ happening at the beginning; first 最初的；开始的；第一的【考研英语大纲词汇】

expedition n. /ˌekspeɪˈdɪʃn/ an organized journey with a particular purpose, especially to find out about a place that is not well known 远征；探险；考察【考研英语大纲词汇】

n. the people, vehicles, animals, etc. taking part in an expedition 踏上征途的一批人（或车、动物等）；考察队；探险队

n. (formal) speed in doing something 迅速；快速；动作敏捷
We will deal with your order with the greatest possible **expedition**. 我们将尽快处理您的订单。

excavation n. /ˌekskeɪˈveɪʃn/ the activity of digging in the ground to look for old buildings or objects that have been buried for a long time (对古物的) 发掘，挖掘【考研英语大纲词汇】

erosion n. /ɪˈrəʊʒ(ə)n/ the fact of soil, stone, etc. being gradually damaged and removed by the waves, rain, or wind 侵蚀；腐蚀；磨损

accelerate v. /ˈækˈseləreɪt/ to happen or to make something happen faster or earlier than expected (使) 加速，加快【考研英语大纲词汇】

Exposure to the sun can **accelerate** the ageing process. 暴露在日光下会加快老化过程。

distribute v. /dɪˈstrɪbjʊːt/ (~ sth to/among sb/sth) to give things to a large number of people; to share sth between a number of people 分发；分配【考研英语大纲词汇】

The organization **distributed** food to the earthquake victims. 这个机构向地震灾民分发了食品。

前缀：dis- 分开，分离

discern vt. /dɪˈsɜːn/ 辨别 (dis- 分开，分离 + cern 观察)

distract vt. /dɪˈstrækt/ 分散(思想) (dis- 分开，分离 + tract 拉，拖)

displace vt. /dɪsˈpleɪs/ 置换 (dis- 分开，分离 + place n. 地点)

anthropologist n. /ˌænθrəˈpɒlədʒɪst/ a person who studies anthropology 人类学家

keen adj. /kiːn/ (~ to do sth) | (~ that...) | (~ on doing sth) wanting to do something or wanting something to happen very much 渴望；热切；热衷于【考研英语大纲词汇】

adj. (~ on sb/sth/on doing sth) (informal) 喜爱；(对...) 着迷，有兴趣

ritual n. /ˈrɪtʃuəl/ a series of actions that are always performed in the same way, especially as part of a religious ceremony 程序；仪规；礼节；(尤指) 宗教仪式

in situ adv. /ɪnˈsɪtjuː/ (from Latin) in the original or correct place 在原位；在原地；在合适的地方

Samples of the rock were examined **in situ** rather than taken to the laboratory. 岩石样本被原地检测，而不是带回实验室。

heritage n. /ˈherɪtɪdʒ/ the history, traditions and qualities that a country or society has had for many years and that are considered an important part of its character 遗产(指国家或社会长期形成的历史、传统和特色)【考研英语大纲词汇】

【 Para.3 】

This is not a new phenomenon. Chinchorro mummies have been **issuing from** the ground since at least the early 20th century. **Initial** expeditions in 1917 transported mummies to museums around Chile, where experts preserved them for study. Archeologists also ran **excavations** until the 1990s.

这一现象由来已久。早在20世纪初，钦乔罗木乃伊就开始陆续出土。1917年的首次考察行动中，人们将木乃伊运往智利各地的博物馆，交由专家妥善保存并开展研究。此后，考古发掘工作一直持续到了20世纪90年代。

【 Para.4 】

But **erosion** caused by extreme winds and increasing human activity nearby has been **accelerating** the mummies' exposure. The region has run out of space to receive the bodies and keep them preserved. It would take hundreds of trucks to **distribute** them all, says Mr Borie. "There is nowhere to keep the mummies in museums without exposing them to damaging light and temperatures," says Veronica Silva, an **anthropologist** at the Natural History Museum in Santiago, Chile's capital.

然而，极端强风造成的侵蚀，加上附近人类活动日益频繁，使木乃伊暴露的速度不断加快。如今，该地区安置并保存这些遗体的空间已经消耗殆尽。博里表示，如果要把这些遗体全部转移，需要数百辆卡车。“博物馆里根本没有能防止木乃伊遭受有害光线和温度破

makeshift adj. /'meɪkʃɪft/ used temporarily for a particular purpose because the real thing is not available 临时替代的；权宜的

A few cushions formed a **makeshift bed**. 临时用几个垫子拼了一张床。

SYN provisional, improvised

relocate v. /'ri:ləʊ'keɪt/ especially of a company or workers to move or to move sb/sth to a new place to work or operate 尤指公司或工人（使）搬迁，迁移【考研英语大纲词汇】

The firm may be forced to **relocate** from New York to Stanford. 公司也许会被迫从纽约迁移到斯坦福。

up v. /ʌp/ to increase the price or amount of something 提高...的数量（或价格）【考研英语大纲词汇】

The buyers **upped** their offer by £1 000. 买方把出价增加了1 000英镑。

constituent n. /kən'stɪtjuənt/ a person who lives, and can vote in a constituency (选区的) 选民，选举人【考研英语大纲词汇】

The senator met with **constituents** to hear their concerns. 参议员会见了选民以听取意见。

collaboration n. /kə'læbə'reɪʃn/ (~ with sb) (on sth) (~ between A and B) the act of working with another person or group of people to create or produce sth 合作；协作【考研英语大纲词汇】

resident n. /'rezɪdnt/ a person who lives in a particular place or who has their home there 居民；住户；

There were confrontations between local **residents** and the police. 当地居民和警察之间有过冲突。

坏的存放地点。”智利首都圣地亚哥的国家自然历史博物馆人类学家维罗妮卡·席尔瓦（Veronica Silva）说。

【 Para.5 】

And so archaeologists **keen** to learn more about the Chinchorro's months-long mummification **rituals** are having to study the bodies **in situ**, reburying them when they are finished. "Until we have the right technology, we prefer keeping them underground instead of excavating more," says Camila Castillo, also of Chinchorro Marka. A new museum that is under construction south of Arica should help.

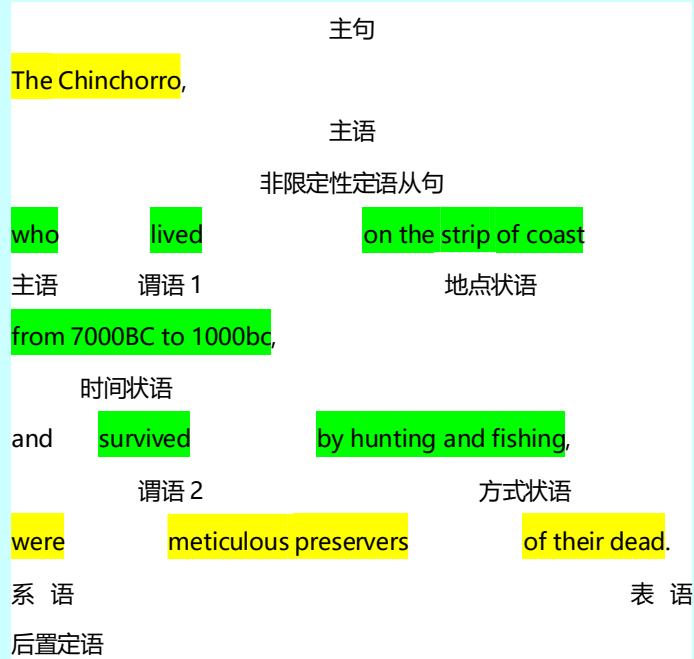
因此，迫切希望进一步了解钦乔罗人持续数月之久的木乃伊制作仪式的考古学家，如今不得不在原地进行遗体研究，结束后再将其重新埋葬。“在我们拥有合适的技术之前，我们宁愿让它们继续待在地下，也不愿再发掘更多遗体。”同样来自钦乔罗考古保护协会的卡米拉·卡斯蒂略（Camila Castillo）说。目前，阿里卡以南正在筹建一座新博物馆，这或许能改善现状。

【 Para.6 】

In 2021 UNESCO added the Chinchorro remains and their landscape to its list of world **heritage** sites. That presented a possible solution: developing the sites into a tourist attraction, and hosting many of the mummies there. But not everyone is happy with that. A small fishing community has

►今日句子分析

Para. 1 The Chinchorro, who lived on the strip of coast from 7000BC to 1000bc, and survived by hunting and fishing, were meticulous preservers of their dead. 公元前7000年至公元前1000年间，以狩猎和捕鱼为生的钦乔罗人在这片狭长海岸地带繁衍生息，他们对死者遗体进行了极为细致的保存。



主句:

主语: The Chinchorro;

非限定性定语从句:

主语: who; 谓语1: lived; 地点状语: on the strip of coast; 时间状语: from 7000BC to 1000bc; (英语的表达顺序大致是: 人物 → 地点 → 时间 → 生存方式, 因为中文中, 时间状语非常自由, 而且经常放在句首。因此, 译文中的时间信息被提前。其中, BC是Before Christ的缩写, 译为“公元前”。)

连词: and; 谓语2: survived; (此处的lived和survived并列, 共享同一个逻辑主语The Chinchorro, 即who lived ... and survived ... live的基本意思是“生活、居住、生存”, 放到历史民族语境中, 繁衍生息会更自然、更有历史叙述感。)

方式状语: by hunting and fishing;

系语: were; 表语: meticulous preservers; (中文对应含义为“极其细致的保存者”, 但是“钦乔罗人是他们死者极为细致的保存者”这句话极为不自然, 利用汉语的动态表达倾向, 将抽象名词还原为动作, 可以减少这种汉语名词化过程中出现的不自然感。)

后置定语: of their dead; (their指The Chinchorro, 即钦乔罗人的。)

(这句话的信息较多, 可以先抓句子主干: The Chinchorro were meticulous preservers of their dead. 其余who lived ... survived by hunting and fishing都是The Chinchorro的补充信息。原文介绍的顺序是人物→地点→时间→生存方式, 但汉语往往习惯将时间前置, 译文也是如此。)

illegally built **makeshift** homes in the Camerones valley within the site. UNESCO would like them to **relocate**, but they are not so keen. Meanwhile their numbers are growing, and their presence is increasingly damaging the remains.

2021年，联合国教科文组织将钦乔罗遗存及其所在景观列入世界遗产名录。此举提供了一种可能的解决方案：将这些遗址开发成旅游景点，并将大量木乃伊就地安置。但并非所有人都乐意。一个小型渔业社区在遗址范围内的卡马罗内斯河谷非法搭建了若干临时住所。联合国教科文组织希望他们搬迁，但居民们并不积极。同时，这个社区的人口还在不断增加，而他们的存在对这些遗存造成的破坏也越来越严重。

【 Para.7 】

The local mayor, Christian Zavala, has **upped** the tension by saying the mummies get more attention than his **constituents**. But some older residents like José Concha, who has lived in the area for more than 30 years, understand the economic opportunities they offer. "I'm becoming too old to go fishing," he says. "I would love to become a tour guide to teach tourists about the mummies."

当地市长克里斯蒂安·萨瓦拉（Christian Zavala）更是让紧张局势进一步升级。他表示，这些木乃伊得到的关注比当地居民还多。不过，一些年长的居民看到了遗骸背后的经济机遇。何塞·孔查（José Concha）在当地生活了30多年，他表示：“我年纪太大，捕不了鱼了。我希望能做个导游，向游客讲解这

➤ 写作积累

1. (Para. 4) "There is nowhere to keep the mummies in museums without exposing them to damaging light and temperatures," says Veronica Silva, an anthropologist at the Natural History Museum in Santiago, Chile's capital.

本句中 Expose...to...表示 "to place someone or something in a position where they experience, face, or come into contact with an influence, element, or risk"，即“使.....暴露于...”，例如，His rationale is that he only wants to expose this particular metadata to the developers. 他打算仅将这些特定的元数据公开给开发人员。此外，还有以下习语可以表示类似的含义：

put... at the risk of... idiom to cause a person, object, or situation to face a new or elevated chance of suffering loss, injury, or failure. 使.....处于危险境地；危及.....；置.....于风险之中

We should not put our health at the risk of working too hard. 我们不应该冒着工作过劳的风险损害健康。

leave ... vulnerable to ... idiom to cause someone or something to be exposed, unprotected, and at risk of being harmed, attacked, or damaged by a specific threat 使.....易受.....影响/伤害/攻击

A weak immune system leaves the body vulnerable to infections. 免疫系统低下会使身体易受感染。

2. (Para. 6) But not everyone is happy with that.

文中的 Be happy with 表示 "to feel satisfied, content, or pleased with a specific person, situation, possession, or result"，即“对.....感到满意；对.....感到高兴；乐于接受.....”，例如，I hope that you'll be happy with our work. 我希望你会对我们的工作感到满意。此外，还有以下表达可以表示相同的含义，供写作时选用：

sit well with idiom to be acceptable, agreeable, or pleasing to someone; often used in the negative to show disapproval, unease, or disagreement 得到某人认可；合某人心意；让某人觉得妥当、能接受

Their decision didn't sit well with the Board of Directors. 他们的决定没有得到董事会的认可。

be on board with idiom to be in agreement with a course of action, a plan, or an idea; willing to support or participate 同意、赞成、支持...

Will your new manager be on board with the idea? 你的新上司能接受这个主意吗？

些木乃伊。”

much about Caleta Camarones's future as they do about its past.

【 Para.8 】

Ms Castillo says Chinchorro Marka hopes to raise money to set up a centre where the mummies can be studied and exhibited in **collaboration** with **residents** of Camarones. But if that is to work, the archaeologists will need to show that they care as

卡斯蒂略表示，钦乔罗考古保护协会希望筹集资金，与卡马罗内斯镇当地居民开展合作，建立一座木乃伊研究展示中心。但该计划若要成功，考古学家就必须拿出诚意：他们对卡莱塔·卡马罗内斯镇未来的重视，绝不亚于对其历史的关注。